homegrown

Product & CRO Brief

Changes Shipped + Proposed Dashboard Redesign

Date: March 18, 2026

Prepared by: Growth Team

Status: 10 changes live · 16 proposed

View Interactive Prototype →

1. Changes Already Shipped

All changes below are LIVE on findhomegrown.com as of March 18, 2026.

1A. Signup Page CRO

CHANGE	WHAT WE DID	STATUS	EST. IMPACT
Sticky CTA Bar	Fixed bottom bar: "Start Free — 7 days free, then $10/mo" + button + dismiss X. Hidden on load, appears at 5% scroll, dismissible via cookie.	LIVE	+15-25% form starts
CTA Link Fixes	3 buttons updated from `/signup` to `/signup/basic-annual-2026` (direct checkout). Nav, blog nav, blog CTA.	LIVE	Removes 1 extra click
Microcopy Under CTAs	"7-day free trial · $10/mo after · Cancel anytime" added under 4 CTA buttons on signup + 2 on blog.	LIVE	Reduces commitment anxiety
Blog Nav CTA	Changed from `/signup` to `/signup/basic-annual-2026`	LIVE	Direct to checkout
Blog CTA Section	Bottom CTA link fixed + microcopy added	LIVE	Direct to checkout

1B. Blog UX Improvements

CHANGE	WHAT WE DID	STATUS	EST. IMPACT
Link Font Fix	Links were rendering at 16px/500wt while body text was 18px/400wt. Fixed to inherit from paragraph.	LIVE	Eliminates jarring visual breaks
Table Styling	Added padding, borders, header backgrounds, row lines. Tables were completely unstyled (0 padding, no borders).	LIVE	Tables now readable
Heading Sizes	H2 reduced from 56px to 32px, H3 from 48px to 24px inside rich text.	LIVE	Proper visual hierarchy
Mobile Overflow	Full container chain forced to `max-width:100vw` on mobile. Text was overflowing right edge on phones.	LIVE	All 201 articles fixed
Content Width	Rich text max-width set to 680px (was 880px, ~100 chars/line).	LIVE	Optimal 60-75 char line length

CHANGE	WHAT WE DID	STATUS	EST. IMPACT
Paragraph Spacing	Bottom margin increased from 12px to 20px.	LIVE	Better breathing room
Table of Contents	Auto-generated sticky TOC on right side for all blog articles with 3+ H2 headings. H2s only, scroll-tracking highlight, reading progress bar, mobile floating button.	LIVE	+15-25% time on page, -10-15% bounce

2. Data That Informed Everything

Key Metrics (144 Hotjar Sessions + GA4)

0.56% Signup page conversion (% of page views)	**2.9%** Form start rate (% of /signup visitors)	**56%** Mobile traffic (majority of all sessions)
292 Saturday spike sessions (58% above avg)	**42-50%** Trial-to-paid rate (2x industry benchmark)	**73%** Choose annual plan (of paying vendors)

Saturday spike insight: 292 sessions on Saturdays (58% above daily average). Vendors are at farmers markets, seeing competitors with online stores, and searching on their phones. This is the highest-intent moment.

Vendor Dashboard Recordings (42 Sessions Analyzed)

90% Product creation abandonment rate	**100%** Tour modal dismissal rate	**0** Orders received in recording window

Critical findings from recordings:

- Image upload blocks every mobile vendor
- SKU field confuses cottage food vendors
- Premature validation errors on untouched fields
- "Add Location" banner covers submit button on mobile
- Vendors obsessively check profile views (0-9 views)
- Both churned vendors were Annual plan — likely got 0 orders

From Adapty State of Subscriptions 2026

Source: 16,000 apps, $3B revenue analyzed

FINDING	DATA POINT	IMPLICATION FOR HOMEGROWN
Trial starts	90% happen Day 0	Optimize first-touch experience above all else
Trial-to-paid benchmark	27.8% industry average	Homegrown at 42-50% is best-in-class
Biggest churn cliff	1st→2nd renewal: 59%→45%	First month retention is everything
Visual/text A/B tests	Win only 34.6% of the time	Structural changes beat cosmetic ones
Structural changes	Win 59% of the time	Invest in form redesign, not button colors
Revenue concentration	Top 10% capture 94.5%	Winner-take-all — speed to market matters

3. Proposed Vendor Dashboard Redesign

Interactive prototype: evan-netizen-1.github.io/homegrown-dashboard-prototype

The Core Insight

The dashboard is designed for an *active* vendor (orders, quick actions, stats) but **100% of new vendors need onboarding guidance**. The product form demands 8 fields upfront when vendors need 3. The most important action (sharing the store link) is buried. Every empty state shows zeros with no guidance.

5 Views in the Prototype

View 1: New Vendor Dashboard

- **Simplified sidebar** (4 items vs 9) — removes Posts, Events, Inventory, Finances, Orders during setup
- **Trial countdown banner** at top (was hidden — Recording #11 shows vendor hunting for this)
- **Setup checklist** replaces tour modal (4 steps, 2 pre-checked for endowed progress effect)
- **Location sequenced BEFORE product** (60 seconds vs 7+ minutes — easy win first)
- **Storefront preview** inline (was buried in settings dropdown)

Research: Endowed progress effect increases task completion by +30%.

View 2: Product Quick Create

- **Only 3 fields visible:** Name, Category, Price (was 8 fields)
- Everything else collapsed under **"Add more details (optional)"**
- **"Write it for me"** AI button on description field
- Images marked **"Optional now. Required before publishing."** (was required upfront — blocks every mobile vendor)
- **No premature validation errors** (was showing red errors for untouched fields)
- SKU moved to bottom, labeled **"Optional"**

Research: Reducing 11 to 4 fields = +120% form conversions (Imagescape study).

View 3: First Product Celebration

- **Full-screen celebration moment** when first product is saved (currently invisible — just returns to product list)
- Pre-written share templates for **Text, Instagram, Copy Link**
- Copy-paste message: *"Hey! I just set up an online store. You can order my sourdough anytime: [link]. Order by Friday for Saturday pickup!"*
- Bridges the gap between **"product saved"** and **"first order"**

View 4: Post-Setup Dashboard

- **Full sidebar unlocked** (all 9 items)
- Hero card: **"Share your store link to get your first order"**
- 3 share methods with pre-written copy: **Text Your Regulars, Post on Instagram, Share on Facebook**
- Store link with **copy button**
- Orders + Stats below (with **empty state messages**, not blank)
- Quick Actions at bottom (relevant now that setup is done)

View 5: Orders Empty State

- **Currently:** Completely blank white page
- **Proposed:** Package icon + "No orders yet" + "Share your store link to get your first order" + orange CTA + help article link

Research: 84% of users abandon products with empty/blank states (Appcues study).

4. All Changes Ranked by Speed & Estimated ROI

26 items total: 10 shipped, 16 proposed. Ranked by ROI score (estimated impact divided by effort).

#	CHANGE	CATEGORY	DEV EFFORT	EST. IMPACT	STATUS
1	**Sticky CTA bar on signup**	Shipped	Quick Win	$80-120/mo	LIVE
2	**Auto-placeholder images by category** — selecting a category auto-assigns a placeholder image. "Don't worry, you can add a photo later."	Product Fix	<1 day	$120/mo	READY TO BUILD
3	**Reduce product form to 3 fields**	Dashboard Redesign	2-3 days	$150/mo	NEEDS DESIGN
4	**Replace tour modal with setup checklist**	Dashboard Redesign	2-3 days	$100/mo	NEEDS DESIGN
5	**Post-setup "Get Your First Order" hero**	Dashboard Redesign	2-3 days	$100/mo	NEEDS DESIGN
6	**Fix premature validation on product form**	Product Fix	<1 day	$80/mo	READY TO BUILD
7	**Add trial countdown to dashboard**	Product Fix	<1 day	$80/mo	READY TO BUILD
8	**Blog Table of Contents**	Shipped	Quick Win	+15-25% time on page	LIVE
9	**Sequence location before product**	Product Fix	<1 day	$60/mo	READY TO BUILD
10	**V11 email (share templates)**	Email	2 hours	$60/mo	READY TO BUILD
11	**CTA link fixes**	Shipped	Quick Win	$50/mo	LIVE
12	**V17b email (Day 6 loss frame)**	Email	2 hours	$50/mo	READY TO BUILD

#	CHANGE	CATEGORY	DEV EFFORT	EST. IMPACT	STATUS
13	**Add orders empty state**	Product Fix	<1 day	Retention	READY TO BUILD
14	**Microcopy under CTAs**	Shipped	Quick Win	$40/mo	LIVE
15	**V5 email (+2h no product nudge)**	Email	2 hours	$40/mo	READY TO BUILD
16	**First product celebration moment**	Dashboard Redesign	1-2 days	Retention + sharing	NEEDS DESIGN
17	**Simplified sidebar during onboarding**	Dashboard Redesign	2-3 days	-55% cognitive load	NEEDS DESIGN
18	**AI description generation**	Dashboard Redesign	2-3 days	Reduces abandonment	NEEDS BACKEND
19	**Remaining onboarding emails (V6, V8, V10, V14, V17a, V17c, V21)**	Email	1 day	Completes sequence	READY TO BUILD
20	**Geographic concentration (GTM)**	Strategy	No Dev	Highest structural impact	IMMEDIATE
21	**Blog link font fix**	Shipped	Quick Win	Readability	LIVE
22	**Blog table styling**	Shipped	Quick Win	Readability	LIVE
23	**Blog heading sizes**	Shipped	Quick Win	Readability	LIVE
24	**Blog mobile overflow fix**	Shipped	Quick Win	Mobile readability	LIVE
25	**Blog content width**	Shipped	Quick Win	Readability	LIVE
26	**Blog paragraph spacing**	Shipped	Quick Win	Readability	LIVE

Legend

LIVE Already shipped READY TO BUILD Can start immediately NEEDS DESIGN Requires design review NEEDS BACKEND Requires backend work

5. Recommended Implementation Sequence

Week 1 — Quick Wins (already live or <1 day each)

- Auto-placeholder images by category (selecting category auto-assigns placeholder; real photo replaces it later)
- Add trial countdown to dashboard
- Sequence location before product in onboarding
- Fix premature validation on product form
- Add orders empty state
- Build V5 email (+2h no product nudge)
- Build V11 email (copy-paste share templates)
- Build V17b email (Day 6 "store goes offline" loss frame)

Estimated combined impact: $460-560/mo in additional revenue

Weeks 2-3 — Medium Effort

- Reduce product form to 3 fields (progressive disclosure)
- Replace tour modal with setup checklist
- First product celebration moment
- Simplified sidebar during onboarding
- Post-setup "Get Your First Order" hero with share templates
- Build remaining onboarding emails (V6, V8, V10, V14, V17a, V17c, V21)

Estimated combined impact: $350-500/mo in additional revenue

Month 2 — Bigger Bets

- AI description generation on product form
- Geographic concentration (GTM strategy shift)

These are highest structural impact but require more coordination

6. Success Metrics

METRIC	CURRENT	TARGET (30 DAYS)	TARGET (90 DAYS)
Time to first product	20-45 min	<10 min	<5 min
Product creation completion	~10%	50%	80%
% vendors who share link	Unknown	40%	60%
Time to first sale	Never (0 orders)	72 hours	48 hours
Trial-to-paid	42-50%	55%	65%
30-day retention	87%	90%	93%
Monthly new vendors	~4/week	8/week	12/week
MRR	~$150	$350	$700

> **North star metric:** Time to First Order (TTFO). Every change in this document is designed to compress the path from signup to first sale. If a vendor gets an order within 72 hours, retention follows naturally.

Homegrown Product Brief — March 2026 — Confidential